

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Is a hipster lifestyle better than other lifestyles?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe taste and style in fashion through a wider range of language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about fashion trends?
- How much do you consider the latest trends when you shop for new clothes?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing, fashion and clothing.
- I can make comparisons using *as ... as* and *not as*.
- I can compare two things or people and describe the quality of an object or a person.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa wants some **faux glasses***!

* "Faux glasses" have plain glass in them for people who don't need glasses to see better.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Melodie was saying that vintage clothing is making a comeback.
- Sally:** Yes. It seems that all the hippest trend setters are wearing it these days.
- Vanessa:** I'm not as tuned into the fashion scene as you are, Sal.
- Sally:** Well, I do read the latest fashion sheets at work. All of the hipsters are into vintage clothing. They're driving some of the styles we see in stores.
- Vanessa:** All those skinny jeans, faux glasses and ironic tops in gingham and paisley. It's a little folksy and Americana. Personally I don't find hipster style as interesting as other ways of dressing. It all seems so contrived!
- Sally:** I think you have to buck the bigger trends. Being a follower is not as compelling as standing out in a crowd. Being seen in some worlds is just as important as blending in others.
- Vanessa:** How do hipsters socialize?
- Sally:** Well, some grow vegetables in garden plots together.
- Vanessa:** Really? That's the most ridiculous way to socialize I've ever heard!
- Sally:** They go to nightclubs and hang out in cafes. They ride their bikes together everywhere. I don't think it's a better lifestyle, just a more distinctive one. They are the thriftiest bunch. It's a cheaper way to live.
- Vanessa:** Hmm ... browsing through thrift stores for lower-priced clothing ... I can be as hipster as the next person!
- Sally:** I didn't see that one coming!





Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Sally are hipper than anyone!

Instructions: Read each of the sentences. Write C if you think a sentence is a comparative, S if it is superlative, or N if you think it is neither comparative nor superlative.

1. ____ I don't think it's a better lifestyle.
2. ____ It's a more distinctive lifestyle.
3. ____ That's the most ridiculous way to socialize I've ever heard.
4. ____ I'm so crazy about the new trend.
5. ____ They are the thriftiest bunch.
6. ____ It's a cheaper way to live.
7. ____ I do read the latest fashion sheets at work.



Let's Practice!

Sal and Vanessa stand out from the crowd!

Instructions: Complete the sentences by writing the corresponding words in each gap. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. There are two sets of words you don't need to use.

as you are

be as hipster as

not as compelling as
standing

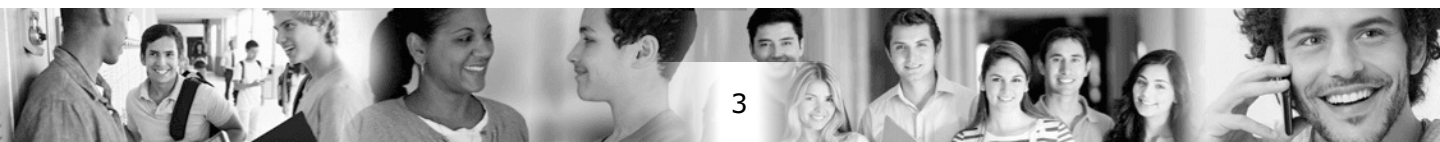
as Sal is

just as important as

are as hipster

as interesting as other ways of dressing

1. I'm not as tuned into the fashion scene _____, Sal.
2. I don't find hipster style _____.
3. Being a follower is _____ out in a crowd.
4. Being seen in some worlds is _____ blending in others.
5. I can _____ the next person!





Extension Activity

Talk about socializing.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of some activities you like to do and places you like to go with friends.
- Discuss which activities are better and which are you favorite (use comparatives and superlatives).
- Write a paragraph describing your perfect weekend.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about socializing.

☐ ☐

I compare social activities and say which ones I like best.

☐ ☐

I write about the perfect social weekend.

☐ ☐

I read my paragraph aloud and correct any errors I find.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **hip** (adjective): cool
e.g. It seems that all the hippest trend setters are wearing it these days.
- **faux** (adjective): made to look real, but not real
e.g. She's wear a faux fur coat.
- **ironic** (adjective): saying one thing, but meaning another
e.g. The saying on her T-shirt is ironic.
- **gingham** (adjective): cotton cloth with two colors in a square pattern.
e.g. Those gingham tops are good to wear in summer heat.
- **paisley** (adjective): patterned with curved shapes
e.g. The paisley tops are totally hip.
- **contrived** (adjective): artificial
e.g. Hipster style seems so contrived!
- **to buck** (verb): to go against
e.g. You have to buck the bigger trends to stand out from the crowd.
- **thrifty** (adjective): using money carefully
e.g. They are the thriftiest bunch because it's cheaper.





Learning Points

Making Comparisons

We use *as* + adjective/adverb + *as* to make comparisons when the things we are comparing are equal in some way:

*This leather jacket is **as soft as** a sweater!*

We use *not as ... as* to make comparisons between things which aren't equal:

*This leather jacket **isn't as expensive as** that one.*

Examples:

- *I'm not **as tuned into the fashion scene as** you are, Sal.*
- *I don't find hipster style **as interesting as** other ways of dressing.*
- *Being a follower is not **as compelling as** standing out in a crowd.*
- *Being seen in some worlds is **just as important as** blending in others.*
- *I can be **as hipster as** the next person!*





Learning Points

Superlatives and Comparatives

You use a comparative to compare somebody or something to **one** other person or thing.

You use a superlative to compare somebody or something to the whole **group** that he, she or it belongs to.

Look at the chart for information on how to form the comparative and superlative:

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative	Form
big	bigger	the biggest	Most adjectives: +er, +-est
late	later	the latest	Adjectives ending in -e: +r, +-st
thrifty	thriftier	the thriftiest	2-syllable adjectives ending in -y: +ier, +iest
ridiculous	more ridiculous	the most ridiculous	3+-syllable adjectives: more + adjective most + adjective
good bad	better (than) worse (than)	the best the worst	Irregular comparisons

- you use **than** after comparatives
- you add **the** in front of the superlative form to describe people, places and things.

Examples:

- *That's the most ridiculous way to socialize I've ever heard!*
- *I think you have to buck the bigger trends.*
- *I don't think it's a better lifestyle, just a more distinctive one.*
- *They are the thriftiest bunch.*
- *It's a cheaper way to live.*

